



FREE CHECKLIST

The Cloud Migration Checklist

Azure • Microsoft 365 • Google Workspace

A practical, vendor-neutral checklist for planning and executing a cloud migration without disrupting your business — covering pre-migration planning, platform-specific steps, and what to check after cutover.

Who this is for	IT managers and business owners planning a move to Microsoft 365, Google Workspace, or Azure
What's inside	Pre-migration planning, platform comparison, three platform-specific checklists, and a post-migration review
Time to read	About 10 minutes

Rua Technologies is an official partner of Microsoft, Google, and AWS, helping businesses across India plan and execute cloud migrations, licensing, and ongoing IT support.
ruatechnologies.com • sales@ruatechnologies.com • +91 91315 71358

BEFORE YOU START

Pre-Migration Planning

The single biggest cause of a rocky cloud migration isn't the technology — it's skipping this planning stage. Work through this list before touching any migration tool.

- Inventory every user, device, mailbox, and shared drive that needs to move
- Identify data that has compliance or residency requirements (e.g. finance, healthcare records)
- Document your current environment: on-prem servers, existing licenses, network topology
- Define what "success" looks like — specific, measurable criteria, not just "it works"
- Choose a migration window that avoids month-end, quarter-end, or other business-critical dates
- Take a full backup of everything being migrated, verified as restorable
- Notify all affected users well in advance, with a clear point of contact for issues
- Identify a rollback plan in case the migration needs to be paused or reversed

Why this matters

Migrations rarely fail because of the cloud platform itself — they fail because of missing inventory, no rollback plan, or users who weren't told what to expect. This stage typically takes longer than the technical migration itself, and that's normal.

DECISION GUIDE

Choosing Your Platform

If you haven't already committed to a platform, here's a quick comparison across the factors that matter most for most businesses.

Factor	Microsoft 365	Google Workspace	Azure
Best fit	Teams already using Office apps, Windows-heavy environments	Teams wanting simplicity, Gmail-based collaboration	Custom apps, infrastructure, and workloads beyond office productivity
Email & docs	Outlook, Word, Excel, Teams	Gmail, Docs, Sheets, Meet	Not applicable — infrastructure platform, pairs with either above

Typical strength	Deep enterprise features, on-prem integration (AD, Exchange)	Ease of use, fast onboarding, lower admin overhead	Scalable compute, storage, and networking for custom workloads
Compliance tooling	Extensive (Purview, DLP, eDiscovery)	Solid, simpler feature set	Extensive, workload-dependent

Many businesses end up running more than one of these together — e.g. Microsoft 365 for productivity and Azure for hosting a custom application. That's normal and often the right call.

PLATFORM CHECKLIST

Microsoft 365 Migration

- Verify domain ownership and configure DNS records (MX, SPF, DKIM, DMARC)
- Choose a mailbox migration method: cutover, staged, or hybrid, based on mailbox count
- Assign the correct license tier (Business Basic/Standard/Premium or Enterprise E1/E3/E5) per user
- Set up Multi-Factor Authentication and Conditional Access policies before go-live
- Migrate mail, calendars, and contacts using a tested migration tool, not manual export/import
- Migrate shared drives and file structures into SharePoint/OneDrive, preserving permissions
- Configure Teams: channels, guest access policy, and meeting settings
- Run a pilot migration with a small user group before migrating everyone
- Schedule a short training session so users know where their files and email now live
- Confirm mail flow and calendar sharing are fully working before decommissioning old mailboxes

PLATFORM CHECKLIST

Azure Migration

- Run a workload assessment: which servers/apps are moving as-is (lift-and-shift) vs. being redesigned
- Design your network topology (VNets, subnets, peering) before deploying any resources
- Right-size VM and storage tiers based on actual usage data, not guesswork
- Set up Network Security Groups and least-privilege access from day one
- Define a backup and disaster recovery strategy for each workload before migrating
- Apply a consistent resource tagging strategy for cost tracking from the start
- Set up Azure Monitor / Log Analytics before cutover, not after something breaks
- Migrate in phases — non-critical workloads first, business-critical systems last
- Test failover and recovery procedures before relying on them in production
- Review your Azure cost estimate against actual spend after the first billing cycle

Google Workspace Migration

- Verify your domain in Google Admin Console and plan the MX record cutover window
- Use Google Workspace Migrate or a comparable tool for mail, calendar, and contacts — avoid manual moves
- Set up organizational units and groups to mirror your existing team structure
- Configure 2-Step Verification and security settings before rolling out to users
- Migrate shared drives, preserving folder structure and sharing permissions
- Set up mail routing rules for the cutover window so no messages are lost mid-migration
- Pilot with a small group first, especially if migrating from an on-prem or different cloud mail system
- Provide a short orientation for users moving from Outlook/Exchange habits to Gmail/Calendar
- Confirm mobile device sync (Android/iOS) is working before decommissioning the old system

AFTER CUTOVER

Post-Migration Review

- Verify data integrity: spot-check mailboxes, files, and permissions against the pre-migration inventory
- Keep old systems in a read-only, decommissioned state for a defined period before deleting anything
- Monitor performance and user-reported issues closely for the first 1–2 weeks
- Collect user feedback and resolve any workflow gaps quickly while they're fresh
- Document the new environment: who has access to what, and how support requests are routed
- Review actual cloud costs at 30, 60, and 90 days against your original estimate
- Revisit security settings (MFA enforcement, sharing defaults) once the dust has settled

Common pitfall to avoid

Teams often decommission the old system too early to "save costs," then discover a missed mailbox or file share weeks later with no way back. Keep old systems in cold storage for at least 30–60 days post-migration.

Need a hand with any of this?

Rua Technologies is an official partner of Microsoft, Google, and AWS. We plan and run cloud migrations end-to-end — from the assessment in Section 1 through the post-migration review in Section 6 — so your

team doesn't have to piece it together alone.

Email	sales@ruatechnologies.com
Phone	+91 91315 71358
Web	ruatechnologies.com/contact